

tmux Cheat Sheet

Keep terminal sessions running in the background, and split one terminal into windows and panes.

Why use it

Programs inside tmux keep running when the terminal closes or SSH drops. Reconnect, run **tmux a**, and it's all still there.

From the shell

Command	Does	Command	Does
tmux	Starts a new session	tmux attach -t work	Reconnects to session work
tmux new -s work	Starts a session named work	tmux a	Reconnects to the last session
tmux ls	Lists sessions	tmux kill-session -t work	Ends session work

The prefix: Ctrl-b, then a key

Ctrl-b then c ← press Ctrl-b together, let go, then press c
[prefix] [key] = new window. Every shortcut below starts with the prefix; % and " need Shift

Sessions and windows (Ctrl-b, then...)

Key	Does	Key	Does
d	Detaches: leaves the session running	0 – 9	Jumps to window number
s	Lists sessions to switch to	w	Lists windows (and sessions) to pick from
\$	Renames the session	,	Renames the window
c	New window	&	Kills the window (asks first)
n / p	Next / previous window		

Panes (Ctrl-b, then...)

Key	Does	Key	Does
%	Splits left right	z	Zooms the pane to full size (again = back)
"	Splits top / bottom	x	Kills the pane (asks first)
arrows	Moves to the pane in that direction	space	Cycles through layouts
o	Moves to the next pane	Ctrl-arrow	Resizes the pane (keep Ctrl held, tap again)

Scrolling back and help (Ctrl-b, then...)

Key	Does	Key	Does
[	Copy mode: scroll with arrows, PgUp, wheel	?	Lists all key bindings (q closes)
q	(no prefix) Leaves copy mode	:	Command prompt, e.g. :kill-server

Reading the status bar

```
[main] 0:bash* 1:vim- "host" 14:02 03-Oct-26
|      |      |      |      +-- pane title (usually the host name), time, date
|      |      |      |      +-- - marks the window you were in last
|      |      |      |      +-- * marks the current window
|      |      |      |      +-- window number : name (the running program)
+-- session name
```

Starter ~/.tmux.conf

```
set -g mouse on   ← click panes, drag borders, scroll with the wheel
unbind C-b   ← optional: use Ctrl-a as the prefix instead
set -g prefix C-a
bind C-a send-prefix   ← Ctrl-a Ctrl-a sends a real Ctrl-a to the program
```

Reload without restarting: Ctrl-b : then **source-file ~/.tmux.conf**.

Remember: Ctrl-b **d detaches** and everything keeps running. Typing **exit** in the last pane **ends** the session for good.